DRILL 17

SALVAGE & OVERHAUL

NFPA 1001 Level 1 (JPR 4.3.13, 4.3.14) / WorkSafeNB Reg 91-191

SALVAGE, WATER CHUTES & OVERHAUL WITH TIC

⏱ **Time:** 45–60 min | 🚒 **Apparatus:** Pumper / Rescue | 🦺 **PPE:** Full Structural Turnout Gear & Gloves

👥 **Roles:** Drill Leader (Facilitator) | Safety Officer (Watcher) | Salvage Crew Pairs

🎯 OBJECTIVE & RURAL FIREGROUND VALUE

Every firefighter must be able to deploy a heavy salvage cover (tarp) using the **Two-Firefighter Balloon Throw**, construct a functional **Water Chute** and **Catch-All Basin** to divert ceiling runoff out of a building, and utilize a **Thermal Imaging Camera (TIC)** alongside pike poles to locate concealed fire in ceilings and wall cavities without causing unnecessary structural destruction.

📦 TOOLS & APPARATUS SETUP

- 2 heavy-duty canvas or vinyl salvage covers (minimum 12' x 14' or 14' x 18').
- 2 pike poles (6-ft fiberglass or wood).
- 1 Thermal Imaging Camera (TIC).
- Simulated furniture pile or tables stacked together.
- Clear water bucket or garden hose for water diversion demonstration.

⚠️ SAFETY WATCH-OUTS & STOP RULE

⚠️ **Overhead Collapse:** During overhaul and ceiling pull, never stand directly underneath the drywall/plaster being pulled. Pull from an angle with your back to an exit!

⚠️ **Eye & Respiratory Protection:** Wear eye protection and keep SCBA on air until the atmosphere has been metered and cleared of toxic particulate and carbon monoxide.

🛑 **THE STOP RULE: Shout "STOP!" immediately if ceiling joists show signs of structural sag or if heavy water buildup threatens catastrophic ceiling collapse.**

PHASE 1: FURNITURE GROUPING & THE BALLOON THROW (15 MINUTES) — SLOW DRY RUN

1. **Grouping Contents:**
   - Move household furniture (dressers, chairs, electronics) to the center of the room, away from exterior walls and light fixtures.
   - Place delicate electronics and photos on top of beds or tables; elevate furniture off wet carpet using blocks.
2. **The Two-Firefighter Balloon Throw:**
   - Two firefighters position on opposite sides of the grouped pile, holding the folded salvage cover.
   - Unfold the cover lengthwise between them.
   - Each firefighter grasps the outer corners with palms facing down.
   - On count: *"1, 2, 3, LIFT!"* Both firefighters make a high, sweeping upward motion, capturing a "balloon" of air beneath the tarp.
   - Guide the floating tarp smoothly over the top of the furniture stack and tuck the bottom edges under the furniture legs to shed water.

DRILL 17: PRACTICAL EVOLUTIONS & TAILGATE DEBRIEF

Salvage & Overhaul • Practical Application

PHASE 2: CONSTRUCTING A WATER CHUTE (15 MINUTES) — BUDDY COACHING

(Used when water is leaking through an upper floor ceiling and must be diverted out a window or doorway)

1. Lay a salvage cover flat on the floor.
2. Place two 6-foot pike poles along the outer edges of the tarp, parallel to each other.
3. Roll the sides of the tarp tightly inward around the pike poles 3 to 4 turns, creating a heavy-duty trough with 6-inch side walls.
4. Position the elevated end beneath the ceiling drip, propped on a ladder, cabinet, or held by a pike pole prop.
5. Direct the lower downhill end of the trough out of an open window or exterior door.
6. Test by pouring a bucket of water down the chute; confirm 100% water diversion without side spills.

PHASE 3: CONSTRUCTING A CATCH-ALL BASIN (10 MINUTES) — TIMED / STRESS

1. Lay salvage cover flat on the floor beneath an overhead leak.
2. Fold each edge inward approximately 3 feet.
3. Fold the corners at 45-degree angles to create interlocking side walls.
4. Result: A waterproof basin that can hold 100 to 200 gallons of dirty runoff, protecting hardwood floors and carpets.

Phase 4: Overhaul with the Thermal Imaging Camera (TIC) (15 Minutes)

5. **Operating the TIC:**
   - Power on TIC; verify battery level and temperature scale mode.
   - Scan technique: Ceiling -> Walls -> Floor in a systematic "Z" sweep.
6. **Identifying Concealed Fire:**
   - Explain white-hot vs colorized temperature gradients.
   - Identify thermal bridges, heat signatures around electrical outlets, recessed lighting, and heating ducts.
7. **Coordinated Ceiling Pull:**
   - Firefighter with TIC identifies hot spot in ceiling.
   - Second firefighter positions with 6-ft pike pole with back to exit.
   - Drives pike pole point through drywall with blade parallel to joists.
   - Twists tool 90 degrees across joists and pulls down with body weight, stepping backward to let debris fall safely ahead.

⚠️ COMMON PITFALLS & FIREGROUND HAZARDS

- ❌ *Pulling ceiling directly above your head:* Falling plaster, sheetrock, and insulation will crush your helmet, obscure your vision, or drop hot embers down your coat collar. Always pull away from you!
- ❌ *Using dirty/punctured salvage covers:* A torn tarp simply funnels dirty water onto the homeowner's valuables. Inspect and wash covers after every fire.

🗣️ 5-MINUTE TAILGATE DEBRIEF

1. ***"Did the balloon throw clear the pile without snagging?", "How much cleaner is overhaul when directed by a TIC rather than blind pulling?"***

✅ APPARATUS RESET CHECKLIST

- [ ] Salvage covers washed clean of mud and soot, hung to dry, or folded into standard firefighter accordion fold.
- [ ] Pike pole heads cleaned and inspected for cracks.
- [ ] TIC screen wiped with soft cloth; battery clicked into charger.
- [ ] Attendance roster signed.

DRILL LEADER SIGNATURE	SAFETY OFFICER SIGNATURE	DATE COMPLETED	TRAINING HOURS